

8.1 The Technologies

Though not all of us are too interested in the technologies that power our personal mobile devices, it is important to understand what will empower our devices in the future. It's the only way to make educated guesses at what the future devices will be.

Form Factors

Form factors of devices have reduced like crazy over the years. As you've already seen in Chapter 1, mobiles have come a long way. Today we are able to use our mobile devices for almost everything we can do on PCs—even multiplayer gaming. And all these features have to fit into a device that's truly mobile and pocketable.

In fact, we've noticed that it's design and form factors that are currently driving the industry. The stiff competition in the mobile arena has resulted in similarly-priced handsets from different manufacturers, with almost identical features. Increasingly, consumers are opting for one device over another based solely on design and form factor. This, obviously, has prompted manufacturers to spend even more time and money on design.

The future, as we see it, isn't going to be much different: manufacturers will still try and cram a host of features into tiny devices, with innovative and distinguishable designs.

Though this trend may lead you to believe that our devices might virtually disappear, or at least become small enough to be completely concealable, there are some factors that are preventing this from happening...

